# What Happened After the Cross?

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Manuscript excerpt

### Introduction: The Acts of the Apostles and the Ministry of the Saints

This book was born out of a powerful and consistent message from our pastor: The call to be a difference-maker in the Kingdom of God. True laborers in the faith are not simply spectators—they actively participate in the work of the Gospel. This is the ministry of the saints, operating under the leadership of the five-fold ministry—apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors, and teachers (Ephesians 4:11).

But what exactly were the Acts of the Apostles?
What was their daily life like?
What kind of work did they do?
How did their faith influence their families and their communities?

While history does not provide us with every personal detail of Paul, Peter, John, and the other early church laborers, what we do have is a powerful record of their actions—a collection of defining moments that give us insight into the foundation of the early church.

The Central Question: "How Were You Baptized?"

One question echoes throughout the Book of Acts:
"How then were you baptized?"

This was not a minor detail for the apostles. It was a foundational truth—the very heart of the early church's growth and mission. The Acts of the Apostles revolve around this central theme: leading believers into the new birth experience as taught and demonstrated by Jesus.

Viewing Acts Through the Lens of the Cross

This book is designed for anyone seeking biblical truth about baptism and the new birth experience. It is a compilation of every example of biblical baptism recorded in Acts. However, to truly understand Acts, we must first look through the lens of the Cross.

A believer must first receive the revelation of the Cross—that Jesus died for their sins, was buried, and rose again. Faith begins with the understanding that Jesus' sacrifice made a way for salvation. But faith alone is not enough—we must respond in obedience, just as the apostles did.

By looking at the Book of Acts through the correct lens, we see that the apostles were not just preaching repentance; they were leading people into the full experience of salvation. They preached:
Faith in Jesus Christ
Baptism in Jesus' Name (Acts 2:38, Acts 8:16, Acts 10:48, Acts 19:5)
The Infilling of the Holy Spirit (Acts 2:4, Acts 10:44-46, Acts 19:6)

The Apostolic Pattern of the New Birth

This book will explore the new birth as experienced by the apostles, using four distinct areas of study for each recorded event:

Location – Where did this event take place?

Circumstances – What led up to this moment?

Experience – What happened when the believer responded?

Conclusion – Is this experience consistent with other Acts accounts?

Structure of This Book

Each chapter will include three key components:

The Story – A narrative account based on scripture.

The Scriptural Reference – A direct look at what the Bible says.

The Historical Context – Insights from historical sources, including Josephus and the Preacher’s Homiletical Commentary.

All Scriptural References are taken from the New King James Version (NKJV) to maintain clarity and accuracy.

A Prayer for Revelation

My prayer for you, dear reader, is the same prayer Paul prayed for the church. As you go through this book, I encourage you to pray earnestly for a spirit of wisdom and revelation to guide you into truth.

Ephesians 1:15-23 (NKJV)
"Therefore I also, after I heard of your faith in the Lord Jesus and your love for all the saints, do not cease to give thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers: that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give to you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of Him, the eyes of your understanding being enlightened; that you may know what is the hope of His calling, what are the riches of the glory of His inheritance in the saints, and what is the exceeding greatness of His power toward us who believe, according to the working of His mighty power which He worked in Christ when He raised Him from the dead and seated Him at His right hand in the heavenly places, far above all principality and power and might and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this age but also in that which is to come. And He put all things under His feet, and gave Him to be head over all things to the church, which is His body, the fullness of Him who fills all in all."